# City of Cambridge

POR 2026-179
**FIRST IN COUNCIL**
September 28, 2026

COUNCILLOR AL-ZUBI
COUNCILLOR SOBRINHO-WHEELER

WHEREAS: Paraprofessionals, substitutes, and clerks in the Cambridge Public Schools provide direct instructional, clerical, and support services to students and staff, including students with disabilities and students who are multilingual learners, and are essential to the daily functioning of the District; and

WHEREAS: The paraprofessionals of the Cambridge Public Schools are represented by Unit E of the Cambridge Education Association, one of six bargaining units through which the Association represents approximately 1,500 District employees, and the Association and the Cambridge School Committee have been in negotiations since early 2026, with the District reporting more than seventeen formal bargaining sessions as of September 4, 2026; and

WHEREAS: As reported by Cambridge Day on June 17, 2026, the starting salary for a paraprofessional working a seven-hour day in the Cambridge Public Schools is $31,640.25; and

WHEREAS: The City Council does not set the terms and conditions of employment of Cambridge Public Schools employees, which are matters within the jurisdiction of the School Committee and the subject of collective bargaining between the School Committee and the Cambridge Education Association, and the City Council expresses no view on the conduct of those negotiations by either party; and

WHEREAS: The City Council may nonetheless speak for itself on matters affecting the people who work in Cambridge, as it did on June 1, 2026, in adopting Policy Order 2026-108 in support of hotel workers represented by UNITE HERE Local 26; and

WHEREAS: That nothing in this order is intended to request information concerning the bargaining positions of either party, or to interfere in any way with the conduct of those negotiations; and

ORDERED: That the Cambridge City Council go on record expressing its support for the paraprofessionals, substitutes, and clerks of the Cambridge Public Schools represented by the Cambridge Education Association, and its view that those who support the education of Cambridge students should be able to afford to live in the community they serve; and be it further

ORDERED: That the City Manager be and hereby is requested to report back to the City Council within thirty days on the status of the negotiations between the Cambridge School Committee and the Cambridge Education Association, in executive session if the Law

Department advises that a report in open session would disclose collective bargaining strategy.

A true copy;

ATTEST:-

Paula M. Crane,
Interim City Clerk

# City of Cambridge

That the City Manager is requested to report back to the City Council within thirty days on the status of the negotiations between the Cambridge School Committee and the Cambridge Education Association, in executive session if the Law Department advises that a report in open session would disclose collective bargaining strategy Support for Cambridge Public Schools paraprofessionals, substitutes, and clerks.